OWNER'S GUIDE · VERSION 1.0

Morse Electric Motor Co.

Website & Staff Admin: How It Works

A reference for the owner and staff of Morse Electric Motor Co.
Covers the public website, customer accounts and the /admin area.
morseelectricmotor.com

October 2026 · Applies to the Phase 1 release of the website

Contents

1 About this guide 4

1.1 Who this guide is for 4

1.2 How the guide is organized 4

1.3 Conventions 4

2 System overview 5

2.1 The three areas of the website 5

2.2 What the website does and does not do 5

2.3 How a request moves through the system 5

3 The public website 7

3.1 Header, navigation and colour themes 7

3.2 Home page 7

3.3 Shopping the catalog 8

3.4 Product pages 9

3.5 Quote requests 9

3.6 Service requests 10

3.7 Contact page 10

3.8 Spam protection 10

4 Customer accounts 12

4.1 Accepting an invitation 12

4.2 Signing in and forgotten passwords 12

4.3 Requests & repairs tab 12

4.4 Company details tab 13

4.5 Forms are filled in automatically 13

5 The staff admin 14

5.1 Signing in and out 14

5.2 Finding your way around 14

5.3 The dashboard 14

5.4 Managing products . . . 15
5.5 Product photos . . . 17
5.6 Importing and exporting spreadsheets . . . 17
5.7 The quote inbox . . . 19
5.8 The service inbox . . . 20
5.9 Customers . . . 20
5.10 Settings . . . 22

6 Everyday tasks . . . 23
6.1 Start of day . . . 23
6.2 When a unit moves through the shop . . . 23
6.3 Weekly price and stock update . . . 23
6.4 A regular customer wants online access . . . 23
6.5 Taking a product off the website . . . 23

7 Setup and settings . . . 24
7.1 Adding a staff member . . . 24
7.2 Business details shown on the website . . . 24
7.3 Email (Resend) . . . 25
7.4 Spam protection (Cloudflare Turnstile) . . . 25
7.5 How long sign-in links last . . . 25
7.6 Customer logins need the server key . . . 25

8 Troubleshooting . . . 26

9 Open items and what's next . . . 27
9.1 Information needed from Morse . . . 27
9.2 Planned next . . . 27

Appendix A Glossary . . . 28
Appendix B Quick reference . . . 29

1 About this guide

This guide explains how the Morse Electric Motor Co. website works for customers, and how you and your staff run it day to day from the admin area.

1.1 Who this guide is for

The owner of Morse Electric Motor Co. and any staff member who handles quote requests, repair jobs, the parts catalog or customer accounts. Chapters 2 to 6 need no technical background. Chapter 7 covers one-time setup tasks, normally done with your web developer.

1.2 How the guide is organized

Chapter	What it covers
2 System overview	What the website does, its three areas, and how a request moves from a customer to your staff.
3 The public website	Every page a customer sees: the catalog, product pages, the quote and repair forms.
4 Customer accounts	What an invited customer can do after signing in.
5 The staff admin	Signing in, the dashboard, products, photos, spreadsheet import, the two inboxes, customers and settings.
6 Everyday tasks	Short checklists for the jobs you will do most often.
7 Setup and settings	Adding staff, business details, email, spam protection and other one-time settings.
8 Troubleshooting	Common problems, what causes them and how to fix them.
9 Open items	Information the website still needs from Morse, and what is planned next.
Appendices	Glossary and a quick reference card.

1.3 Conventions

When you see	It means
Bold text	A button, link, menu item or field label exactly as it appears on screen. Example: click **Save changes**.
`/admin/products`	A page address. Add it to the end of the website's address, for example `morseelectricmotor.com/admin/products`.
NOTE	Extra information that helps you understand what is happening.
TIP	A quicker or better way to do something.
IMPORTANT	Something that cannot be undone, or that affects customers. Read it before you continue.

2 System overview

The website is a catalog and request system. Customers find parts and ask for prices or repairs online; your staff answer those requests from a private admin area.

2.1 The three areas of the website

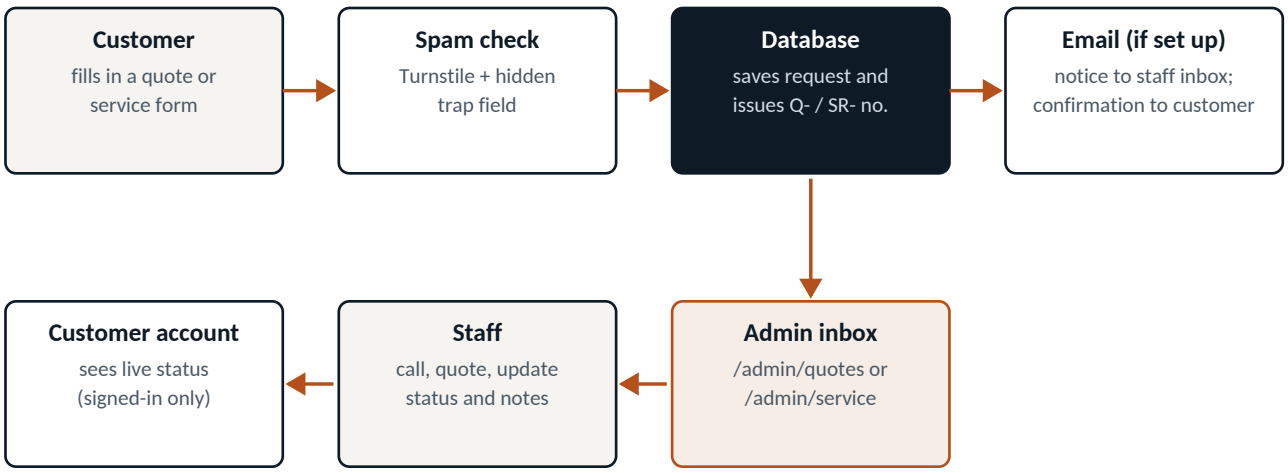
Area	Address	Who uses it	Purpose
Public website	`/`, `/shop`, `/service` …	Anyone	Browse the catalog, read about repair services, send quote and service requests.
Customer accounts	`/account`	Customers you invite	Track repair jobs, see quote requests, keep company details and a tax certificate on file.
Staff admin	`/admin`	Morse staff only	Manage products, photos and stock; work the quote and service inboxes; manage customer accounts.

2.2 What the website does and does not do

In this release (Phase 1), the website does **not** take payments or online orders. Every sale starts as a request. A customer asks for a price or a repair, and your staff follow up by email or phone. This keeps pricing, freight and core charges in your hands while the catalog is being built out. Online checkout is planned for Phase 2 (see Chapter 9).

2.3 How a request moves through the system

Every quote request and service request follows the same path:



1. The customer fills in the quote form or the service request form on the website.
2. The website checks that the visitor is a person, not a spam program (see Section 3.8).
3. The request is saved and given a reference number. Quote requests are numbered `Q-1001`, `Q-1002` and so on; service requests are numbered `SR-1001`, `SR-1002` and so on.
4. If email is set up, your staff inbox receives a notice and the customer receives a confirmation that shows the reference number.
5. The request appears in the admin inbox. Staff contact the customer, then update the request's status and private notes.
6. If the customer has an account, they see the new status the next time they open their account page.

> **NOTE**
>
> A request is always saved before any email is sent. If email is down or not yet set up, nothing is lost: the request is still in the admin inbox. Make a habit of checking the dashboard, not only your email.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Changing a request's status in the admin does **not** send the customer an email. Customers with an account see the change on their account page; everyone else hears from you only when you call or email them.

3 The public website

This chapter walks through the website from a customer's point of view, so you know what they see before they contact you.

3.1 Header, navigation and colour themes

Every page shares the same header.

- **Top bar.** Shows the 24/7 emergency service line, your hours and address, a **Customer login** link, and the colour theme switch.
- **Main menu. Shop parts**, **Repair & service**, **Field service** and **Contact**.
- **Search box.** Customers can type a part number, horsepower or frame size (for example `184T`) to search the catalog.
- **Theme switch. Light**, **Mid** and **Dark** colour themes. The choice is remembered in that visitor's browser. First-time visitors see the site's default theme, which is Light unless you change it (Section 5.10).

> **NOTE**
>
> Every colour combination in all three themes is tested automatically against the WCAG AA contrast standard, so text stays readable for customers with low vision and on phones in bright light.

3.2 Home page

The home page (`/`) is designed to get a customer to the right part or the right repair quickly. From top to bottom it contains:

Section	What it does
Hero and part finder	Buttons to **Shop motors & parts** and **Get a repair quote**. The **Find a replacement** box lets a customer enter equipment type, horsepower, RPM, frame and power from a nameplate and jump straight to matching parts.
Product lines	One card for each of the six product lines, with links to shop that line or request a repair.
Ready on the shelf	Up to four **featured**, in-stock products. You choose which products are featured (Section 5.4).
Repair or replace?	Your five-step repair process, from drop-off to warranty.
Shop & field services	Six service cards that link to the service request form.
Industries	The industries you serve.
Motor down right now?	The emergency phone line and a link to request service online.

> **NOTE**
>
> The home page refreshes its featured and stock information automatically about every five minutes. When you save a product in the admin, the change normally appears right away.

3.3 Shopping the catalog

The catalog is at `/shop`. Each product line also has its own page, for example `/shop/electric-motors`. The six product lines are:

Product line	Address
Electric motors	`/shop/electric-motors`
Pumps	`/shop/pumps`
Blowers	`/shop/blowers`
Vacuum pumps	`/shop/vacuum-pumps`
Starters & controls	`/shop/starters-controls`
Alternators	`/shop/alternators`

Customers narrow the list with these filters:

Filter	Choices
Condition	New, Remanufactured, Used · tested, Exchange
In stock only	Hide products with no stock on hand
Horsepower	Minimum and maximum HP
Speed (RPM)	Nameplate speed bands: 3600/3450, 1800/1750, 1200/1150, 900/875
Enclosure	TEFC, ODP, TENV, Explosion-proof, Washdown, Other
Power	AC single phase, AC three phase, DC
Frame	Any frame designation, for example 56C, 184T, 326TS
Brand	Brands in the catalog
Sort	Best match, Horsepower low to high, Horsepower high to low, Name A–Z

Customers click **Apply filters** to update the list. Results show 12 products per page. The filters are saved in the page address, so a filtered list can be bookmarked or shared.

> **TIP**
>
> Because filters live in the address, you can send a customer a ready-made list. For example, `/shop/electric-motors?hp=5&in_stock=1` shows every 5 HP electric motor in stock.

3.4 Product pages

Each product has its own page at `/products/<product-slug>`. A product page shows:

- **Condition choices.** When the same unit is listed in more than one condition (for example New and Exchange), the page lists every condition with its price and stock, and the customer can switch between them. You link conditions together with the **Family** field (Section 5.4).
- **Price.** The price, or *Price on request* when no price is entered.
- **Stock.** *In stock* when you have units on hand; otherwise *Special order*.
- **Core charge.** For exchange units, a line such as *Plus $150 refundable core charge, credited when your old unit comes back*.
- **Request button. Request price & availability** (no price entered) or **Request a quote** (price entered). Both open the quote form with the part already filled in.
- **Overview, Specifications, Documents** and **Warranty** sections.
- **Shipping.** Ships by ground parcel, ships by LTL freight (quoted for the customer), or pickup only.

Product pages also include structured product data that search engines such as Google use to show price and availability in search results.

3.5 Quote requests

The quote form is at `/quote`. When a customer arrives from a product page, the form shows the product they are quoting and its part number.

Field	Required?	Notes
Part number	See note	Shown only when the customer did not come from a product page. Can be your part number or the manufacturer's.
Name	Yes	
Company	No	
Email	Yes	Quotes are sent here.
Phone	No	
Quantity	No	1 to 10,000.
What do you need?	See note	Nameplate details, application or timing.

The customer must give either a part number or a description; they cannot send an empty request. After sending, the customer sees *Quote request received* with the reference number, and is told to expect a reply by email, usually within one business day.

3.6 Service requests

The repair and service page (`/service`) describes what you repair and your field services, and contains the service request form.

Field	Required?	Notes
What needs service?	Yes	Electric motor, Pump, Blower, Vacuum pump, Starter, Alternator or Something else.
Name	Yes	
Company	No	
Phone	Yes	Required, because repair jobs usually start with a call.
Email	Yes	
Make / brand, HP / size, Model / serial	No	From the nameplate.
What's it doing?	Yes	Symptoms, for example tripping the breaker or noisy bearings.
Schedule a pickup	No	Customer wants your truck to collect the unit.
Line is down: rush	No	Marks the job as rush. Rush jobs are listed first in the admin.
Quote a replacement too	No	Customer wants a repair-or-replace comparison.

After sending, the customer sees *Request received* with the job number, and is told that a service coordinator will call to arrange drop-off or pickup.

3.7 Contact page

The contact page (`/contact`) shows your phone number (with a note that the emergency line is answered 24/7), shop address and counter hours, and email address. These details come from website settings, not from the admin; see Section 7.2 to change them.

3.8 Spam protection

The public forms use two layers of protection:

- **Cloudflare Turnstile.** A free, privacy-friendly check that usually runs invisibly. Occasionally a visitor is asked to tick a box.
- **A hidden trap field.** People never see it, but spam programs fill it in. Those submissions are quietly discarded.

Customers who are signed in to their account skip the Turnstile check, because you invited them.

> **NOTE**
>
> If something does get through, set its status to **Spam** in the admin (Section 5.7). Spam is hidden from the open inbox and is never shown to customers.

4 Customer accounts

Customer accounts are invite-only. There is no public sign-up page; your staff create each account from the admin (Section 5.9). This chapter describes the account from the customer's side.

4.1 Accepting an invitation

When you invite a customer, they receive (or you send them) a one-time link.

1. The customer opens the link. The page says *Welcome to Morse*.
2. They click **Continue**.
3. They choose a password of at least 10 characters and type it again to confirm.
4. They click **Save password**. They are now signed in and see their account page.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Invitation and sign-in links expire. The default is one hour (Section 7.5). If a customer's link has expired, open their record in the admin and click **Make a new sign-in link**.

4.2 Signing in and forgotten passwords

Customers sign in from **Customer login** in the top bar (`/account/login`) with their email and password. If they forget their password, they click **Forgot your password?**, enter their email, and receive a one-time link to choose a new one.

> **NOTE**
>
> **Forgot your password?** works only when email and Turnstile are both set up. Until then, make a new sign-in link for the customer from the admin.

4.3 Requests & repairs tab

This is the first page a customer sees after signing in.

Repair jobs

Each repair job shows the equipment, job number, date sent and a **Rush** badge if applicable, followed by a progress bar with six steps:



Example: a job with status In repair shows the first four steps complete.

Under the progress bar is a plain-language status message, for example *Your unit is being repaired*. The customer can also expand **What you told us** to see their original description. Section 5.8 shows exactly which admin status moves the bar to which step.

Quote requests

A table of the customer's quote requests with reference, part, date sent and status. Customers see these labels: *Received*, *Quote sent*, *Ordered* and *Closed*. A note reminds them that prices are sent by email and that they reply or call to order.

4.4 Company details tab

- **Contact.** Name, company and phone. The sign-in email is shown but cannot be changed by the customer; they are asked to call you.
- **Shipping address** and **Billing address**, with a **Same as shipping** option.
- **Sales tax.** The customer can upload a tax-exemption or resale certificate (PDF, JPEG or PNG, up to 3.5 MB). Only the customer and your staff can see it. Once you approve it (Section 5.9), the page says *Your account is tax-exempt*.

4.5 Forms are filled in automatically

When a signed-in customer opens the quote or service form, their name, company, email and phone are filled in for them, and a note explains that the request will appear in their account. Requests sent while signed in are linked to the account automatically.

5 The staff admin

The admin is where you manage the catalog and answer customers. It is available only to people you have set up as staff.

5.1 Signing in and out

1. Go to `/admin`. If you are not signed in, you are taken to the **Staff sign in** page.
2. Enter your staff email and password.
3. Click **Sign in**. The dashboard opens.

To sign out, click **Sign out** in the admin header. Always sign out on shared computers.

> **NOTE**
>
> A customer login cannot open the admin, even if someone knows the address. The website checks staff access on every admin page and every action. To give someone staff access, see Section 7.1.

5.2 Finding your way around

The admin menu has seven items:

Menu item	Address	Use it to
Dashboard	`/admin`	See what needs attention today.
Products	`/admin/products`	Search, add, edit, archive or delete products; manage photos and stock.
Import CSV	`/admin/import`	Update many products at once from a spreadsheet.
Quotes	`/admin/quotes`	Work the quote request inbox.
Service	`/admin/service`	Work the repair and service job inbox.
Customers	`/admin/customers`	Invite customers, approve tax exemption, send sign-in links.
Settings	`/admin/settings`	Choose the colour theme new visitors see.

5.3 The dashboard

The dashboard answers one question: *what needs attention today?* It shows four tiles. Click any tile to open the matching list.

Tile	Counts	Opens
New quote requests	Quote requests with status New.	Quotes inbox

Tile	Counts	Opens
Open service jobs	Jobs from Received through Ready. A note shows how many are marked rush.	Service inbox
Active products	Products listed on the site. A note shows how many drafts are waiting.	Products, active only
Out of stock	Active products with no stock on hand.	Products, active and out of stock

Tiles that need action are highlighted when their count is above zero. Below the tiles are shortcuts to **Add a product** and **Import a parts spreadsheet**.

5.4 Managing products

Open **Products** to see the catalog as a table with product, category, condition, price and status. Use the search box and the status and stock filters, then click **Filter**. From this page you can also **Add product**, **Import CSV** or **Export CSV**.

To add a product

1. Click **Add product**.
2. Fill in the fields described in the table below. At minimum, enter a **SKU**, **Name** and **Category**.
3. Click **Create product**. The product's edit page opens, where you can add photos.

To edit a product

1. Open **Products** and click the product.
2. Change any field.
3. Click **Save changes**. The message *Saved. Changes show on the site straight away* confirms the update.

Product fields

Section	Field	What to enter
Basics	SKU	Your part number. Must be unique. Used to match rows in spreadsheet imports.
	Name	The product name customers see.
	Category	One of the six product lines.
	Brand	Pick an existing brand or type a new one; new brands are added automatically.
	Manufacturer part #	Optional. Customers can search by it.
	Condition	New, Remanufactured, Used · tested or Exchange.
	Status	Draft, Active or Archived (see below).

Section	Field	What to enter
	Feature on the home page	Tick to show the product in *Ready on the shelf* when it is in stock.
Price and stock	Price ($)	Leave blank to show *Price on request*.
	Core charge ($)	Refundable deposit for exchange units.
	Quantity on hand	Units in stock. 0 or blank on a new product means special order. When editing, leave blank to keep the current count.
	Shipping	Parcel, Freight (LTL) or Pickup only.
	Weight (lb)	Optional.
Specifications	HP	Decimals or fractions are accepted: 0.5, 1/2, 7½.
	RPM, Frame, Voltage	As on the nameplate, for example 1750, 184T, 208-230/460.
	Enclosure, Power	Choose from the list.
	Other specs	One per line, written as *Label: value*. Example: *Service factor: 1.15*.
Listing	Description	The overview text on the product page.
	URL slug	The product's web address. Made from the name automatically if left blank.
	Family	Give two or more products the same family to show them as condition choices on one product page.

Product status

Status	On the website?	Use it when
Active	Yes, listed	The product is ready to sell.
Draft	No, hidden	You are still preparing the listing (photos, price, specs).
Archived	No, hidden	You no longer sell the product but want to keep its record and history.

Stock and the In stock label

The website decides whether a product is *In stock* from its quantity on hand. Enter a quantity above zero and the product shows as in stock; set it to zero and it shows as *Special order*. You do not set the label directly.

Linking conditions with Family

If you sell the same motor as New, Remanufactured and Exchange, create three products (one per condition, each with its own SKU and price) and give all three the same **Family** value, for example `5hp-184t-gp`. Customers then see all three conditions side by side on one product page.

To delete a product

1. Open the product.
2. Click **Delete product**.
3. Read the confirmation and click **OK**.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Deleting a product permanently removes it and its photos. It cannot be undone. If you only want to take a product off the website, set its **Status** to **Archived** instead.

5.5 Product photos

Photos are managed on the product's edit page, in the **Photos** section. You can add photos only after the product has been created.

1. Open the product.
2. Under **Add photos**, choose one or more image files.
3. Click **Upload**. The message *Uploaded N photos* confirms the upload.

- Accepted formats: JPEG, PNG and WebP.
- Up to 3.5 MB per upload. For several large photos, resize them or upload them one at a time.
- The first photo is the **Main photo**, used in the catalog and on the home page.
- To remove a photo, click **Remove** under it and confirm.
- Until a product has a photo, the website shows a placeholder.

5.6 Importing and exporting spreadsheets

Use spreadsheet import to add many products at once, or to update prices and stock across the catalog in one step. The importer reads CSV files, which Excel and Google Sheets can both save.

Before you start

- Click **Download the template** on the **Import CSV** page for a file with every column and example rows.
- Or click **Export current catalog** to download your whole catalog in the same format. Edit it, then import it back.

To import a spreadsheet

1. Save your spreadsheet as CSV. In Excel choose **File > Save As > CSV**; in Google Sheets choose **File > Download > Comma-separated values**.
2. Open **Import CSV**.
3. Choose the file and click **Preview import**. Nothing is saved yet.

4. Review the preview. It shows counts of **New products**, **Updated**, **Unchanged** and **Problems**, and you can expand the lists to see each new product and exactly which fields will change on each updated product.
5. If there are problems, fix them in your spreadsheet, click **Upload a fixed file** and start again. The import cannot be applied while any problem remains.
6. When there are no problems, click **Import N changes**.

Rules the importer follows

- Rows are matched to existing products by **SKU**. A SKU that does not exist yet creates a new product.
- Only the columns in your file are changed. A file with just `sku,price,qty` updates prices and stock and leaves everything else alone.
- New products need a **name** and a **category**.
- A blank price means *Price on request*. A blank status means Active.
- Specs go in one cell, separated by semicolons: `Service factor: 1.15; Insulation: Class F`.
- Files can be up to 1.5 MB and 5,000 rows.

Column names the importer recognizes

You do not need to rename your columns to match the template exactly. These common names are understood:

Field	Accepted column names
SKU	sku, part number, part #, part no, item number, item
Name	name, product name, title
Category	category, product line, type
Price	price, unit price, sell price
Core charge	core charge, core, core deposit
Quantity	qty, quantity, qty on hand, on hand, stock
Brand	brand, manufacturer, make
Manufacturer part #	mfr part number, manufacturer part number, mfr part #, mpn
HP / RPM	hp, horsepower / rpm, speed
Power / Voltage	power, phase / voltage, volts
Shipping / Weight	shipping, ship class / weight, weight lb, lbs
Other	condition, status, featured, frame, enclosure, description, specs, family, slug

Values the importer understands

Column	Examples of accepted values
Price	1299, 1299.50, $1,299

Column	Examples of accepted values
HP	5, 7.5, 7½, 1/2
Condition	New; Remanufactured, Reman, Rebuilt, Refurbished; Used, Tested; Exchange, Core
Enclosure	TEFC, ODP, TENV, XP, Explosion-proof, Washdown, WD, Other (full names also work)
Power	1 phase, single phase, 3 phase, three phase, DC
Shipping	Parcel, UPS, Ground; LTL, Freight; Pickup
Status	Active, Published, Live; Draft, Hidden; Archived
Featured	yes, y, true, 1, x / no, n, false, 0, blank
Category	electric-motors, pumps, blowers, vacuum-pumps, starters-controls, alternators (or the full name)

> **NOTE**
>
> If an import stops part-way (for example, a lost connection), the rows before the problem are saved. Fix the issue and import the **same file** again. Rows already saved show as Unchanged, so nothing is doubled.

5.7 The quote inbox

Open **Quotes** to see quote requests, newest first. Use the tabs above the list to filter: **Open** (the default, showing New requests), each individual status, or **All**.

To work a quote request

1. Click the request to open it. You see the customer's details, the part and quantity, and their message.
2. Contact the customer. Click their email address to start a reply, or their phone number to call.
3. In the **Status** panel, choose the new status.
4. Optionally, add **Staff notes** (up to 4,000 characters), for example the price you quoted or the PO number.
5. Click **Save**.

Status	Meaning	Customer sees
New	Not yet answered. Counted on the dashboard.	Received
Quoted	You have sent a price.	Quote sent
Won	The customer ordered.	Ordered
Lost	The customer did not order, or the request is closed.	Closed
Spam	Not a real request.	Hidden

> **TIP**
>
> Staff notes are private. Customers never see them, so record anything useful there: what you quoted, who you spoke to, follow-up dates.

5.8 The service inbox

Open **Service** to see repair and service jobs. **Rush** jobs are always listed first, then the newest. The tabs work the same way as the quote inbox; **Open** shows every job from Received through Ready.

Opening a job shows the customer's details, the equipment and nameplate details, the symptoms, and whether they asked for pickup, rush handling or a replacement quote. If the customer was signed in, a link opens their customer record. Update the status and staff notes in the same way as a quote request.

Keep the status current as the unit moves through the shop. Customers with an account see it on their progress bar:

Admin status	Progress bar step	Message the customer sees
Received	Received	We've received your request and will be in touch to arrange drop-off or pickup.
Teardown	Inspection	Your unit is in the shop and being inspected.
Quoted	Quote	We've sent you a repair quote. Reply or call us to approve it.
Approved	Repair	Quote approved. Your repair is scheduled.
In repair	Repair	Your unit is being repaired.
Testing	Testing	Repair done. We're testing it under load.
Ready	Ready	Ready for pickup or delivery.
Delivered	Ready (moved to past jobs)	Delivered. Thanks for your business.
Closed	Ready (moved to past jobs)	This job is closed.
Spam	Hidden	Not shown.

5.9 Customers

Open **Customers** to see every customer account, with email, phone, tax status and the date the account was created. Search by name, company or email. The **Tax** column reads *Exempt*, *Taxable*, or *Certificate to review* when a customer has uploaded a certificate you have not yet approved.

To invite a customer

1. Click **Invite customer**.
2. Enter the customer's **Email** (they will sign in with it) and **Name**. Company and phone are optional.
3. Click **Create account & get invite link**.

4. If email is set up, the website emails the link to the customer. Either way, the link is shown on screen; click **Copy link** to send it yourself by email or text.

When the account is created, any earlier requests sent from the same email address are linked to it, so the customer sees their history straight away.

To send a new sign-in link

Use this when a customer lost the invitation, the link expired, or they forgot their password.

1. Open the customer.
2. In the **Sign-in** panel, click **Make a new sign-in link**.
3. Copy the link and send it, or confirm that it was emailed.

To approve tax exemption

1. Open the customer. The **Sales tax** panel shows whether a certificate is on file.
2. Click **Open certificate** and check it.
3. Tick **Tax-exempt (certificate checked)** and click **Save**. The customer's account now says it is tax-exempt.

To remove a customer account

1. Open the customer.
2. Click **Remove account** and confirm.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Removing an account deletes the customer's login and saved details. It cannot be undone. Their past quote and service requests stay in your inboxes. To give them access again, invite them again.

> **NOTE**
>
> An email address that already belongs to a staff login cannot also be used for a customer account. Use a different address for one of them.

5.10 Settings

Open **Settings** to change site-wide options for the public website. Today it holds one option: the **Default theme**, which is the colour theme a visitor sees the first time they open the site.

1. Open **Settings**.
2. Under **Default theme**, choose **Light**, **Mid**, **Dark** or **Match the visitor's device (light or dark)**.
3. Click **Save settings**. The message *Saved. New visitors will see this theme* confirms the change.

> **NOTE**
>
> The default affects first-time visitors only. Anyone who has already picked a theme with the switch at the top of the page keeps their own choice on that device.

6 Everyday tasks

Short checklists for the jobs you will do most often. Each one points back to the full instructions.

6.1 Start of day

- Open the **Dashboard**.
- Answer every **New quote request**, then set each one to Quoted (Section 5.7).
- Open **Service**. Call every new **Rush** job first, then the other Received jobs (Section 5.8).
- Check **Out of stock** for anything you should reorder or restock.

6.2 When a unit moves through the shop

- Teardown started: set the job to **Teardown**.
- Quote sent to the customer: set it to **Quoted** and note the amount in staff notes.
- Customer approved: set it to **Approved**, then **In repair** when work starts.
- On the test stand: **Testing**. Finished: **Ready**. Collected or shipped: **Delivered**.

6.3 Weekly price and stock update

- Click **Export CSV** on the Products page.
- Update the price and qty columns in Excel or Google Sheets. Delete columns you are not changing if you like.
- Import the file and check the preview before you apply it (Section 5.6).

6.4 A regular customer wants online access

- Invite them from **Customers** with the email they already use with you (Section 5.9).
- Send them the link and remind them it expires.
- If they buy tax-exempt, ask them to upload their certificate, then approve it.

6.5 Taking a product off the website

- Temporarily: set its status to **Draft**.
- Permanently, keeping the record: set it to **Archived**.
- Only if it was created by mistake: **Delete** it.

7 Setup and settings

These tasks are done once, or rarely. Some of them happen outside the admin, in the services that run the website. If you are not comfortable with them, ask your web developer.

7.1 Adding a staff member

Staff accounts are created by hand, never through a public sign-up. The database is hosted by Supabase.

1. Sign in to the Supabase dashboard and open the Morse Electric project.
2. Go to **Authentication > Users** and click **Add user**. Enter the staff member's email and a password.
3. Open the **SQL editor** and run the statement below, replacing the email address:

```
insert into public.staff (user_id, role)
select id, 'admin' from auth.users
where email = 'person@example.com';
```

The staff member can now sign in at `/admin`. To remove staff access, delete their row from the `staff` table, or delete the user in Supabase.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> In Supabase, under **Authentication > Sign In / Providers**, make sure public sign-ups are turned off. All staff and customer accounts should be created only by you.

7.2 Business details shown on the website

Your phone number, email, address, hours and service area appear on many pages. They are stored as settings in the hosting service (Vercel), not in the admin. Until a value is set, the website shows a placeholder such as `[PHONE]`.

Setting	Controls
`NEXT_PUBLIC_MORSE_PHONE`	Phone number in the header, contact page and forms. Becomes a tap-to-call link on phones once it is a real number.
`NEXT_PUBLIC_MORSE_EMAIL`	Email address on the contact page.
`NEXT_PUBLIC_MORSE_STREET`	Street address.
`NEXT_PUBLIC_MORSE_CITY`	City, state and ZIP.
`NEXT_PUBLIC_MORSE_HOURS`	Opening hours, for example *Mon–Fri 7:30–5:00*.
`NEXT_PUBLIC_MORSE_SERVICE_AREA`	Area your pickup truck covers.

Setting	Controls
`NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL`	The website's public address. Defaults to `https://morseelectricmotor.com`; leave it unset unless the domain changes.

After you change a setting in Vercel, redeploy the website for the change to take effect.

7.3 Email (Resend)

The website sends email through a service called Resend. Three settings control it:

Setting	Controls
`RESEND_API_KEY`	Connects the website to your Resend account.
`MORSE_EMAIL_FROM`	The sender shown on emails, for example *Morse Electric Motor Co. <service@yourdomain.com>*.
`MORSE_STAFF_EMAIL`	Where new-request notices go. Separate several addresses with commas.

With email set up, the website sends: a staff notice for each new request (replying to it goes straight to the customer); a confirmation to the customer with their reference number; customer invitations and sign-in links; and forgotten-password links.

7.4 Spam protection (Cloudflare Turnstile)

Set `NEXT_PUBLIC_TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY` and `TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY` from your Cloudflare account. On the live website the forms refuse submissions until these keys are set, so that the inbox is not flooded with spam.

7.5 How long sign-in links last

Invitation and sign-in links expire after the time set in Supabase under **Authentication > Providers > Email > Email OTP expiration**. The default is one hour; the maximum is 24 hours. A longer time is more convenient for customers; a shorter time is more secure. Staff can always make a new link.

7.6 Customer logins need the server key

Creating customer accounts, sending sign-in links and removing customers require the `SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY` setting. If it is missing, the admin shows a message asking for it to be added in Vercel.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Treat `SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY`, `RESEND_API_KEY` and `TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY` like passwords. Never email them or paste them into the website.

8 Troubleshooting

Find the symptom in the left column. Work through the fix in the right column.

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
A banner at the top of the page says **Preview catalog**.	The website is not connected to the database.	Ask your developer to check the Supabase settings in Vercel (Section 7.6).
Customers see *Online requests aren't available right now*.	The database connection or server key is missing, or the database is down.	Check the Supabase settings in Vercel. Customers are told to call you in the meantime.
Customers can't send a form; they get a spam-check error.	Turnstile keys are missing or wrong, or the site address changed.	Check the Turnstile settings (Section 7.4). New preview addresses must be added to `TURNSTILE_ALLOWED_HOSTNAMES`.
New requests appear in the admin but no email arrives.	Email is not set up, or the staff address is wrong.	Check the three Resend settings (Section 7.3) and your spam folder. The requests themselves are safe.
Pages show `[PHONE]`, `[EMAIL]` or similar.	Business details are not set.	Set the settings in Section 7.2 and redeploy.
That email and password don't match a staff account.	Wrong password, or the user does not exist.	Check the email. Reset the password in Supabase if needed.
This account isn't set up for staff access.	The login exists but is not in the staff table.	Follow Section 7.1, step 3.
A customer's link says it has expired or is invalid.	The link is older than the expiry time, or was already used.	Make a new sign-in link (Section 5.9).
There's already a customer account for this email.	The customer was invited before.	Open their existing record and make a new sign-in link.
A product doesn't appear on the website.	Status is Draft or Archived.	Set the status to Active and save.
A product shows *Special order* when you have stock.	Quantity on hand is zero.	Enter the quantity and save.
A product is missing from the home page.	Not featured, or out of stock. Only four are shown.	Tick **Feature on the home page** and make sure it has stock.
The import preview shows *Unknown category*.	The category in the file isn't one of the six.	Use one of the names in Section 5.6.
The import says the file is too large.	Over 1.5 MB or 5,000 rows.	Split it into smaller files.
A photo upload is refused.	Wrong format, or over 3.5 MB.	Save it as JPEG, PNG or WebP and resize it.

9 Open items and what's next

The website is built and working, but some content is still a placeholder. These items are needed from Morse before launch.

9.1 Information needed from Morse

Item	Where it appears	How to supply it
Real parts list: SKU, specs, condition, price and stock	Catalog and product pages	Export the template, fill it in and import it (Section 5.6), or send the spreadsheet to your developer.
Product photography	Catalog, product pages, home page	Upload on each product's edit page (Section 5.5).
Warranty terms (currently *[XX]-month*)	Warranty section of every product page	Send to your developer.
Brands you are authorized to sell	Brand filter and product listings	Send to your developer.
Phone, email, address, hours and service area	Header, footer, contact page, forms	Section 7.2.
Shop photography	Home and service pages (currently labelled placeholders)	Send to your developer.

9.2 Planned next

- **Photo uploads on the public forms**, so customers can attach a picture of the nameplate or the damage.
- **Phase 2:** a shopping cart, online card payments with Stripe, core-charge handling at checkout and Net-30 terms for approved accounts.

Appendix A Glossary

Term	Meaning
Core charge	A refundable deposit added to an exchange unit, credited when the customer returns their old unit (the core).
CSV	Comma-separated values. A plain spreadsheet file that Excel and Google Sheets can open and save.
Draft / Active / Archived	Product statuses. Only Active products appear on the website.
Exchange	A condition: the customer receives a rebuilt unit and returns their old one.
Family	A shared label that groups the condition variants of one unit onto a single product page.
Featured	A product chosen to appear on the home page when in stock.
Frame	The NEMA frame size on the nameplate, for example 56C or 184T, which sets the mounting dimensions.
ODP / TEFC / TENV / XP	Enclosure types: Open Drip-Proof; Totally Enclosed Fan-Cooled; Totally Enclosed Non-Ventilated; Explosion-Proof.
Reference number	The number given to each request: Q-#### for quotes, SR-#### for service jobs.
Resend	The service the website uses to send email.
Rush	A service job the customer marked *Line is down*. Listed first in the service inbox.
SKU	Your unique part number for a product. The importer uses it to match rows.
Slug	The readable part of a page address, for example *5-hp-general-purpose-motor*.
Staff notes	Private notes on a request. Only staff can see them.
Supabase	The service that stores the website's data, photos and logins.
Turnstile	Cloudflare's spam check on the public forms.
Vercel	The service that hosts the website and stores its settings.

Appendix B Quick reference

I want to...	Go to	Section
See what needs attention	`/admin`	5.3
Answer a quote request	`/admin/quotes`	5.7
Update a repair job	`/admin/service`	5.8
Add or edit a product	`/admin/products`	5.4
Add product photos	Product edit page > Photos	5.5
Update prices and stock in bulk	`/admin/import`	5.6
Download the whole catalog	`/admin/products/export`	5.6
Invite a customer	`/admin/customers/new`	5.9
Resend a customer's sign-in link	Customer record > Sign-in	5.9
Approve tax exemption	Customer record > Sales tax	5.9
Change the default colour theme	`/admin/settings`	5.10
Add a staff member	Supabase dashboard	7.1
Change phone, address or hours	Vercel settings	7.2